

ing stones. The security officers were left with little choice and opened fire to try and quell the rioters.

Reddy, on his part, has his own coterie of supporters led by MLA Konda Surekha who quit the state ministry, stating she was unwilling to work under Chief Minister Konijeti Rosaiah. In addition, Congress MLA Malothu Kavitha and Congress MLAs Pulla

Telangana issue, Reddy, in defiance of the Andhra Pradesh Government, the Congress and some well-wishers, set out from Hyderabad, hoping to make the most of his father's political legacy.

His belligerent move has displeased the Congress. It does not want Rosaiah to face unwarranted pressures as Reddy's tour escalates tensions. Following the forced return to Hyderabad, the unrepentant Reddy complained to Governor ESI. Narasimhan about his piquant position, ignoring both the chief

Reddy mellowed down but maintained that he was "given a clear indication to do what I am supposed to be doing". "Already some problems have been created. In the best interests of the party and the state Government, he need not go anywhere now," says Moily, adding, "I categorically told him to postpone the tour but it seems he told the media exactly the opposite." Reddy claims that the *yatra* will resume from June 8 in Srikakulam and that he will travel to Telangana districts after the 12 by-elections to

AICC FROWNS ON REDDY'S (LEFT) ODARPU YATRA; CHIRANJEEVI'S PRP MAY TURN OUT TO BE AN UNLIKELY ALLY FOR THE CONGRESS



The Cost of Defiance

How Reddy infuriated the party

- Annoyed the high command by painting himself as successor to his father as chief minister
- Couldn't come clean on allegations regarding his growth in business
- Defied party diktat to abandon the *odarpu yatra* that caused tensions
- Made intemperate remarks against Chief Minister Rosaiah and ageing cabinet ministers
- Criticised the weaknesses of the Congress's governance in the state

Padmavathi and Konda Muralidhar Rao along with other supporters were waiting to receive Reddy at the Mahbubabad railway station—the first stop on the Warangal tour. They even clashed with the protesters.

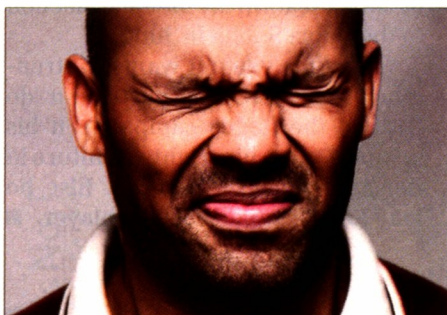
Reddy's opposition to the idea of a separate Telangana has been an eyesore for the TRS and that explains their protests against Reddy Junior touring Telangana districts. Despite being advised against travelling at a time when tensions were simmering over the

minister and Andhra Pradesh Congress Committee President (APCC) Dharmapuri Srinivas. He announced that Rosaiah should take the responsibility for the violence in Mahbubabad and that he would take up the matter with AICC President Sonia Gandhi.

When that meeting did not materialise and both Union Law Minister Veerappa Moily, who looks after Congress affairs in Andhra Pradesh, and Sonia's Political Secretary Ahmed Patel asked him to abandon his tour,

the state legislative assembly in the region are completed by August.

With the reprimand, Reddy has suffered a major loss of face. Many of his supporters in the state Cabinet have rallied behind Rosaiah and found fault with Reddy for his intemperate remarks against the chief minister. Ironically, YSR addressed Rosaiah as *anna* (elder brother) and leaned heavily on him for managing the state's finances. As for Reddy's criticism, Rosaiah takes it in his stride. "At my



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